ENG-0023: System Postmortem for payroll-gateway (System ID: SYS-018)

Impact

The payroll-gateway system, part of Project Yukon, experienced a hardware failure incident (INC-100) that affected its operational stability. The incident was classified as Sev3, indicating a moderate impact on system functionality. The resolution required 25.5 hours, during which time certain payroll processing functions were temporarily disrupted. The system's criticality is rated as medium, emphasizing the importance of timely resolution to maintain payroll integrity and compliance.

Timeline

- **Incident Reported:** The incident was reported by employee E-070.
- **Incident ID:** INC-100
- **Date of Resolution:** The issue was resolved after 25.5 hours.
- **Resolution Completion:** The hardware failure was addressed, restoring normal system operations.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-100 was identified as a hardware failure within the payroll-gateway system infrastructure. This hardware failure led to system downtime and operational disruption. The failure was unrelated to software issues, given the hardware-centric root cause.

Action Items

- Conduct a comprehensive hardware audit for payroll-gateway to identify potential vulnerabilities.
- Implement proactive hardware monitoring to detect early signs of hardware degradation.
- Review and update hardware maintenance schedules to prevent recurrence.
- Ensure that Michelle Evans, the on-call QA Engineer, is involved in post-incident testing to validate system stability after hardware repairs.
- Coordinate with Connor West, the project lead for Project Yukon, to incorporate hardware resilience improvements into the ongoing project plans.

This postmortem underscores the importance of hardware reliability within the payroll-gateway system and highlights the need for ongoing preventative measures to mitigate future incidents.